

Saying hello for the first time

If you meet people your baby doesn't know, you may find that he is shy and wants to cling to you. Although stranger anxiety is normal at this age—and may last for a couple of years—rather than force your baby to be friendly, try these simple steps:

- ❁ Warn your acquaintance in advance that your baby will be more comfortable if they approach him slowly and interact gently using a soft tone.
- ❁ Keep your baby in your arms to begin with and talk to him, explaining who the newcomer is.
- ❁ If your baby is sitting on the floor, suggest that the newcomer gets down on his level and passes him a favorite toy to build a sense of familiarity.
- ❁ Give your baby lots of praise and encouragement if he smiles back at the newcomer.

